

A Finished StoryDogs Example

The Cake That Went for a Walk • An original story outline

Read one step at a time. Ask: "What happened because of the step before it?"

- 1 WHO?** Bea is a bear baker who hates asking for help.
- 2 LIFE / WANT** She bakes alone and wants to make a giant cake for Mouse's birthday picnic.
- 3 UH-OH!** The cart carrying her cake rolls down a hill.
- 4 TROUBLE** Bea tips flour across the path to slow the cart, but its wheels skid.
- 5 WORSE!** The cart speeds toward the duck pond. The cake wobbles like jelly in an earthquake.
- 6 CLIMAX** Bea calls her friends to stretch a picnic blanket across the path. They catch the cake, frosting first.
- 7 CHANGE** Bea invites friends to bake with her. Mouse requests blanket cake every birthday.

Teacher note

The rolling cart starts the problem. Bea's flour idea makes it worse, putting Mouse's birthday cake at risk. Her choice to ask for help changes the outcome.

The Cake That Went for a Walk

Pixar Story Rule #4 narrative form, with the StoryDogs closing line

Once upon a time there was a bear baker named Bea who hated asking for help.

Every day, she baked alone and dreamed of making a giant cake for Mouse's birthday picnic.

One day the cart carrying her cake rolled down a hill.

Because of that, Bea tipped flour across the path to slow the cart, but its wheels skidded.

Because of that, the cart sped toward the duck pond. The cake wobbled like jelly in an earthquake.

Until finally Bea called her friends to stretch a picnic blanket across the path. They caught the cake, frosting first.

Ever since then, Bea has invited friends to bake with her. Mouse requests blanket cake every birthday.

"Ever since then" is the StoryDogs extension. It is not part of Pixar's original six-line rule.

Teacher note

The climax is Bea calling for help and joining her friends to catch the cake. The ending shows a lasting change: she now bakes with others. The cake is messy; the birthday still works.